

TaskWA

Installation Guide

From an empty computer to a working WhatsApp task manager in about thirty minutes.

macOS (Apple Silicon & Intel) · Windows · Linux · Version 1.3

What you'll end up with

- ✓ Docker Desktop running with two TaskWA containers up
- ✓ The setup wizard completed at localhost:3000
- ✓ Your bot number paired to WhatsApp via QR
- ✓ A live morning digest landing on real phones

Easiest way — let AI set it up with you

recommended

No coding needed. Paste this prompt into ChatGPT, Claude, or any AI assistant — it reads this guide and walks you through the install, one step at a time. Prefer to do it yourself? The full steps follow.

```
Help me install TaskWA on my computer. First, ask me what computer I use (Mac, Windows, or Linux). I'm not technical, so explain each step simply, give me one step at a time, and wait for me to confirm before the next one. Help me fix any errors. Here's everything about it:  
github.com/sudhakar-kadavasal/taskwa
```

Illustrations are drawn representations of the real screens; exact appearance varies slightly by version.

1 Before you begin — what you need

Item	Details
A computer that stays on	Mac (Apple Silicon or Intel), Windows 10/11, or Linux. 4 GB RAM is plenty. This machine is the server: reminders only go out while it is awake and Docker is running.
A WhatsApp number for the bot	Either a dedicated SIM (safest) or your own personal number (supported via Personal-number mode — understand the ban-risk trade-off in the User Manual first).
A phone with that number's WhatsApp	Needed once, to scan a QR code.
30 minutes	Most of it is Docker downloading things.

Every command in this guide is also in `INSTALL.txt` in the project folder — open it side-by-side and copy-paste each block in order.

2 Install Docker Desktop

Docker runs TaskWA's three components in isolated containers — it is the only software you install yourself.

macOS: download from docker.com/products/docker-desktop — choose Apple Silicon for M1/M2/M3/M4 Macs, Intel otherwise. Open the .dmg, drag Docker into Applications, then launch it once and approve the system prompts.

Windows: the installer enables WSL2; if it complains about virtualization, enable it in BIOS/UEFI (usually 'SVM' or 'VT-x'). Linux: `curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com | sh`

DOCKER DESKTOP

```
Engine started - ready to run containers
taskwa-app-1      ..... Running
taskwa-waha-1     ..... Running
```

Fig. 1 — Docker Desktop running, with both TaskWA containers up (as it will look after step 4).

3 Get TaskWA and set your secrets

Open Terminal (macOS: Cmd-Space, type Terminal · Windows: PowerShell) and run:

```
git clone https://github.com/sudhakar-kadavasal/taskwa.git
cd taskwa
```

Then paste this whole block — it creates your `.env`, generates all three secrets automatically, and detects your CPU to enable the ARM gateway image when needed. On Windows, run it in Git Bash, not PowerShell:

```
cp .env.example .env
for key in WEBHOOK_SECRET APP_SECRET WAHA_API_KEY; do
  val=$(openssl rand -hex 24)
  sed -i '' "s|^$key=.*|$key=$val|" .env
done
grep -q change-me .env && echo '!! secrets NOT set' \
|| echo 'secrets OK'
```

The last line must print secrets OK. If it doesn't, edit `.env` by hand: run `openssl rand -hex 24` three times, paste one result into each secret, and on Apple Silicon / Raspberry Pi uncomment `WAHA_TAG=arm` — without it Docker reports 'no matching manifest for linux/arm64'.

4 Start it

This step needs Docker running — you installed it in step 2, right? If not, get it now, launch it once, wait for the whale icon, then come back.

```
TERMINAL

$ docker compose up -d
[+] Running 2/2
 ✓ Container taskwa-waha-1   Started
 ✓ Container taskwa-app-1   Started
$ docker compose ps
taskwa-app-1      Up 15 seconds
```

Fig. 2 — First start. The initial run downloads ~1 GB; give it a few minutes. Both containers must show "Up".

5 The setup wizard

Open <http://localhost:3000> in your browser. TaskWA starts in dry-run mode — nothing is sent to anyone until you switch it off, so you cannot accidentally spam your team while setting up.

`localhost:3000/setup`

- 1 Admin password
- 2 Pair WhatsApp [SCAN_QR_CODE]
- 3 Timezone & daily send time
- 4 Team members
- 5 Test & finish

Fig. 3 — The five wizard steps, in order.

- Step 1 — Admin password. Eight characters or more. This protects the dashboard.
- Step 2 — Pair WhatsApp (next section — the only step involving a phone).
- Step 3 — Timezone and send time. IANA name (Asia/Dubai, Asia/Kolkata) and the daily digest time, 24-hour clock. Several times? Comma-separate: 08:00, 17:30.
- Step 4 — Team members. Name + WhatsApp number, digits only with country code (9715xxxxxxx). Add yourself first, as admin.
- Step 5 — Test. Send the test message; in dry-run it appears in the Health page log rather than on your phone — that is correct. Click Finish.
- Using your own personal number as the bot? After the wizard, open Settings and tick Personal number mode — the bot stays silent on everything that isn't a command.

6 Pairing WhatsApp — the QR scan

On the bot number's phone: WhatsApp > Settings > Linked devices > Link a device. Point the camera at the QR shown in the browser. Status becomes WORKING within ~30 seconds.

If the QR does not appear: wait 60 seconds (the gateway boots a full browser engine internally — slower on Apple Silicon's first run), click Start / restart session, refresh. The status label above the QR tells you the state; you want it to end at WORKING.

7 Groups, first test, go live

- Register groups. Add the bot's number to each WhatsApp group you want covered. Dashboard → Groups → Detect my groups → Register. Unregistered groups are ignored entirely.
- Personal number? Settings → tick Personal number mode → Save. Your own digest arrives in WhatsApp's 'Message Yourself' chat.
- Dry-run rehearsal. Health → Run digests now → read the message log. What you see there is exactly what would have been sent.
- Go live. Settings → untick Dry-run → Save. Health → Run digests now — this time the messages land on phones.
- Prove the loop. From your phone: /mytasks → create a test task with /add → reply 1 done → watch for the thumbs-up and the dashboard updating.

8 If something goes wrong

Symptom	Fix
docker: command not found	Docker Desktop isn't installed or was never launched. Launch it, wait for the whale, open a NEW terminal window.
o matching manifest	Apple Silicon / Raspberry Pi: add WAHA_TAG=arm to .env, then docker compose up -d.
QR never appears / FAILED	Wait 60 s → Start/restart session → refresh. Persisting: docker compose up -d --force-recreate waha.
Replies do nothing	Is the sender registered with the exact number they message from? Is the group registered? Check docker compose logs app.
Locked out of dashboard	'Forgot password' sends a code to the admin's WhatsApp. Gateway down too: docker compose exec app python -m app.cli reset-password.